

NHS Satisfaction Analysis

British Social Attitudes Survey 2021 | R | Quantitative Research

Research question

Does NHS satisfaction differ across income, marital status, children, sex, education and age?

Sample and approach

Complete-case analytical sample: **N = 3,307**. Mean NHS satisfaction = **2.60**. Non-substantive responses were excluded. Age bands were represented using midpoints. The five-point satisfaction outcome was treated as continuous for parametric analysis; $\alpha = 0.05$.

NHS satisfaction by income

Income band	Mean satisfaction
< £1,410	2.49
£1,411–£2,560	2.70
£2,561–£4,350	2.66
£4,351+	2.56

Key statistical results and interpretation

Analysis	Result	Interpretation
Sex t-test	$t = -0.78$, $p = 0.437$	Not statistically significant
Education χ^2	$\chi^2 = 10.84$, $df = 6$, $p = 0.093$	Not significant at 5%
Age regression	$\beta = 0.00117$, $p = 0.717$; $R^2 \approx 0$	No evidence of a linear association

Descriptive patterns

Married/cohabiting respondents had a mean of 2.63; divorced/separated 2.52; widowed 2.88 ($n = 16$, so interpret cautiously); single 2.55. Respondents with children averaged 2.56 versus 2.63 for those without children.

Limitations and conclusion

Residual normality is not fully satisfied because the outcome is discrete. Other limitations include treating an ordinal outcome as continuous, possible complete-case bias and the cross-sectional design. Overall, the examined socio-demographic characteristics show only weak evidence of systematic differences in NHS satisfaction.